

Research Question is the start of your journey

Sociology 310 Discussions, Week 2

Agenda

- Self Introductions
- Syllabus
- Brief Review - research question, conceptualization
- Some Information - paper searching, citation generator
- Group Work - Assignment #1
- Check Out

Hello!

about myself...

- Haorui sounds like “how-ray” if that helps
- Nanjing, China
- Michigan Sociology '25 + Senior Thesis Program
- Social Stratification and Mobility (RC28) w/ quantitative methods
 - relative intergenerational mobility
 - education
 - China

Hello!

about you

- Name
- Pronoun (if applicable)
- Hometown
- Thing(s) you'd want us know (if any)

Syllabus

Files: Canvas/Sections/Sections 004 & 005

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Fall 2026

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☐	 Syllabus. fa26_soc_310_section. ...	Sunday	11:32am	Haorui Peng	125 KB		

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Files (alternative): haoruiiii.github.io/teachings/en-us/fa26-soc-310/

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GSI: Sociological Research Methods | 彭浩瑞 Peng, Haorui

彭浩瑞 Peng, Haorui

About CV Papers Projects Blog Teaching Others

Course Information

Course Overview

Section Goals and Structure

Schedule

Announcements

Schedule

Week	Date	Topic	Materials
0		Course Materials	Syllabus
1	Sept. 4	No Discussion	
		We will start next week!	

Announcements

The announcements are listed from the newest to the oldest.

Project Groups Created

Sept. 8, 08:18 ET

Dear Students,

I hope you had a nice Labor Day weekend. As you may have noticed, I have created your final project groups. All members of your group are in the same section, and you will be working in groups of four or five.

When making up the groups, my top priority is your topic interests; I managed to ensure that, for each member in the groups, the topic assigned is at least a 4 (with 1 as the best). I also take into account your preferences on generative AI and work time. Students with the same generative AI preferences are grouped together. When it comes to work time, I tried my best so that most groups will have at least one option (weekday days, weekday nights, and weekends) working for you. If you cannot find some time at which all of you are available, maybe it's a good idea to use group work time in lecture and discussion to meet and talk about your jobs.

For the group number, that on the tens digit represents that which section you are in, and that on the unit digit is arbitrary.

(I was manually typing all your names; sorry in advance if I had typos.)
See you in class!

^

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Syllabus

- Attendance & Participation are mandatory, and communication is the key
- Emails:
 - “SOC 310” should be the beginning of your subject
 - address me as Haorui (or Mr. Peng if you want some formality), not “Dr.” or “Prof.”
- Office Hours:
 - regularly 1 p.m. - 3 p.m. on Fridays, LSA 4253; schedule in advance if possible

Brief Review

Bloome, Deirdre, Shauna Dyer, and Xiang Zhou. 2018. "Educational Inequality, Educational Expansion, and Intergenerational Income Persistence in the United States." *American Sociological Review* 83(6):1215-1253.

RQ Elements

- Population
e.g., U.S. citizens
- Factors (2 or more)
e.g., i). higher education expansion and ii). relative intergenerational mobility
- Relationship between Factors
association v.s. causation
- So, for example,
“How has U.S. higher education expansion impacted its relative intergenerational mobility (across cohorts)?”

Conceptualization

- To form a *clear* definition of abstract terms
- usually, it helps you to
 - make your terms understandable to most of your audiences
 - avoid different interpretations of the terms among different individuals
 - prepare for next steps, including operationalization

Conceptualization

w/ my example on mobility

- “How has U.S. higher education expansion impacted its relative intergenerational mobility (across cohorts)?”
- To define relative intergenerational mobility, Bloome, Dyer, and Zhou (2018:1215) said, “In closed societies, the children of high-income parents become high-income adults, while the children of low-income parents become low-income adults. In open societies, by contrast, adults’ income are less constrained by their parents’ incomes. ... intergenerational income persistence helps characterize the openness of a society” They further paraphrased that lower mobility means that more people remaining on their parents’ rungs on the income ladder and fewer folks moving onto different rungs.

Conceptualization

w/ my example on mobility

- To define relative intergenerational mobility, Bloome, Dyer, and Zhou (2018:1215) said, “In closed societies, the children of high-income parents become high-income adults, while the children of low-income parents become low-income adults. In open societies, by contrast, adults’ income are less constrained by their parents’ incomes. ... intergenerational income persistence helps characterize the openness of a society” They further paraphrased that lower mobility means that more people remaining on their parents’ rungs on the income ladder and fewer folks moving onto different rungs.
- Another way is, according to Xie et al. (2022), to say, “Intergenerational social mobility refers to the extent to which the social status of individuals resembles that of their parents.”

Conceptualization

w/ my example on mobility

- To form a *clear* definition of abstract terms
- usually, it helps you to
 - make your terms understandable to most of your audiences
 - avoid different interpretations of the terms among different individuals
i.e., to specify that I'm not talking about, say, movements in cities
 - prepare for next steps, including operationalization
e.g., the authors will look at income

Conceptualization

v.s. operationalization, w/ my example on mobility

- Bloome et al. (2018) said,
“... intergenerational income persistence helps characterize the openness of a society”

Conceptualization

v.s. operationalization, w/ my example on mobility

- Bloome et al. (2018) said,
“... intergenerational income persistence helps characterize the openness of a society by *quantifying the association* between parents' incomes and their children's incomes during adulthood.”

Some Information

Paper Searching

#1, Google Scholar

- "" to search with exact wording
- AND / OR for logical connections between key words; for OR, use ()
- try some paraphrasing
- whom has this article cited? who have cited this article?

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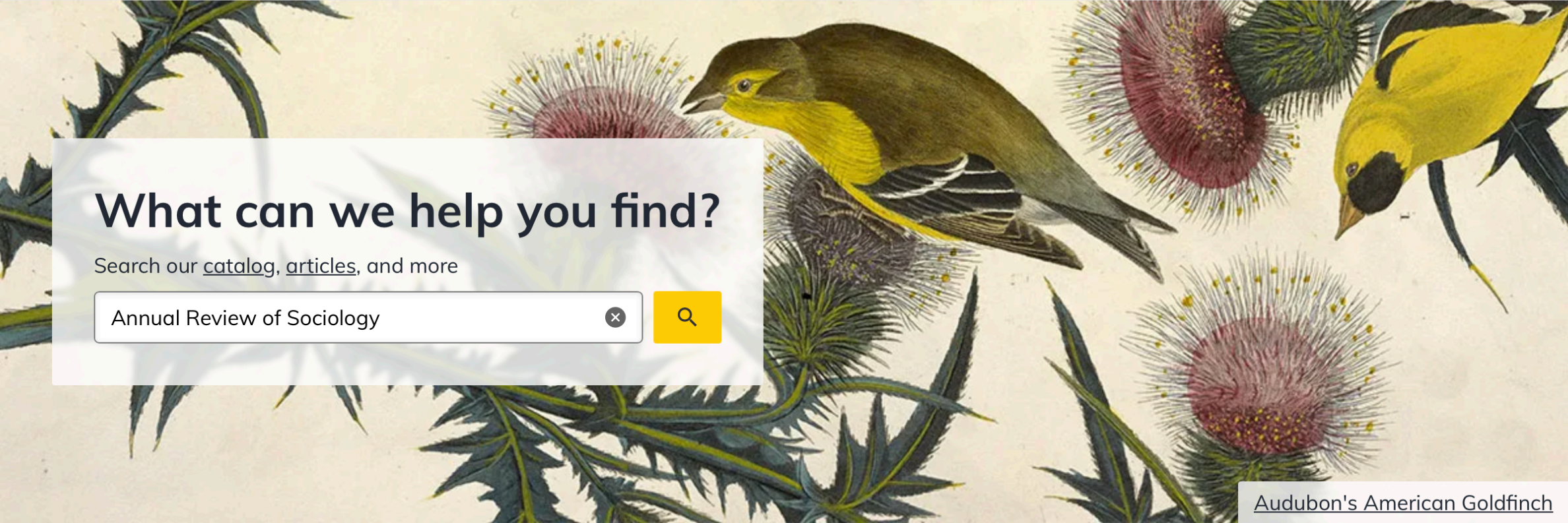
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Database

The Campaign for Nuclear Disarmament (CND) is a UK organization that advocates the abandonment of nuclear weapons by the UK and the world.

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English

Numbering

Vol. 1 (1975)-

Current Publication Frequency

Annual

Source of Description Note

Print version record.

Note

Vol. 47 (2021).
Refereed/Peer-reviewed
Also issued in print.

Physical Description

1 online resource

Media Format

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1545-2115

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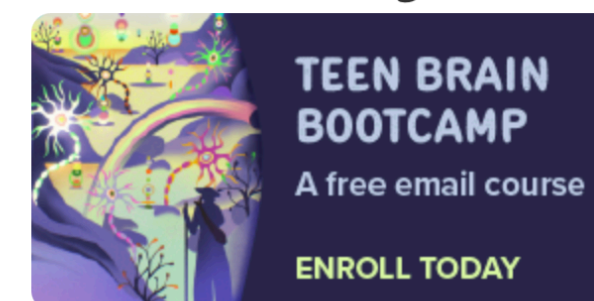
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[Tertiarization Like China](#)

Source: Annual Review of Economics 15, pp. 485 - 512 (2023)
Sep 2023
Article
[Xilu Chen, Guangyu Pei, Zheng Song...](#)
This article documents a rapid shift toward services (tertiarization) of the Chinese economy since 2005, as evidenced by the significant increase in both employment and value-added shares of the service sector. Notably, our analysis reveals that a variety of measures of productivity growth have been consistent since 2005.
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[Social Structure of World Regions: Mainland China](#)

Source: Annual Review of Sociology 3, pp. 179 - 207 (1977)

Aug 1977

Article

[M K Whyte](#), [E F Vogel](#) and [W L Parish Jr.](#)

[Inequality and Social Stratification in Postsocialist China](#)

Source: Annual Review of Sociology 45, pp. 363 - 382 (2019)

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[The Blackwell Encyclopedia of Sociology by George Ritzer \(Editor\).](#)

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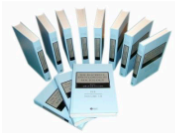
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Group Work

Assignment #1

- ~10 min, Group Contract
- By far, in your planning log, there should be summary notes for each article of your choice
- ~5 min, read each others' summaries
- the rest of time, consider:
 - more "sociological" way to state your RQ? e.g., terms you learned in your lit review
 - is the RQ too broad or too narrow? does it have the "good characteristics"?
 - how can your readings help you with introduction (context) and conceptualization?

Assignment #1

- due Sunday, September 13
- submit 3 things:
 - **Group Contract** (completion)
 - **Planning Log** (completion)
 - **Essay** (grading criteria provided)

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